

HOKA UTMB MONT-BLANC 2026 / UTMB / 176.8 KM / SUHA

CREW SHEET – FROM LES HOUCHE

FOUR CREW POINTS · HOW YOU ACTUALLY GET THERE

RACE START

FRI 28/08

17:45

Chamonix

CREW BASE

100 Rte de la Gare

LES HOUCHE

Next to the station – not Chamonix

FINISH CUTOFF

SUN 30/08

16:30

Chamonix

ALL TIMES

LOCAL, 24H

FR / IT / CH are all UTC+2 – no clock changes

1/2

READ THIS FIRST

FOR LES CONTAMINES GO DOWN-VALLEY VIA SAINT-GERVAIS – NEVER VIA CHAMONIX

The Chamonix > Contamines shuttle's **last outbound is 20:30 Friday** – finished before Suha's arrival window at km 32.5 even opens, and it runs one way only. **Saint Gervais <> NDG runs every 20 min until 01:00** – straight through that window, past the 00:00 cutoff, and on your side of the valley. Take the train down; Chamonix never enters the plan.

LES HOUCHE GARE → TRAIN → LE FAYET → SAINT GERVAIS UNVERIFIED HOP → SHUTTLE EVERY 20 MIN → CONTAMINES (UTMB)

U3

LES CONTAMINES

KM 32.5 · FOOD · ASSISTANCE OK

CUTOFF

SAT 00:00

FRANCE PASS

FRIDAY NIGHT

DIFFICULTY

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GO DOWN-VALLEY VIA SAINT-GERVAIS. DO NOT GO VIA CHAMONIX.

ROUTE OUT – BE IN PLACE BY 21:00

1

TRAIN – MONT-BLANC EXPRESS, DOWN-VALLEY

Les Houches → Le Fayet (Gare)

Two minutes on foot from base to platform. Free with the Guest Card; land by ~20:00.

UNVERIFIED

Times at Les Houches. Photograph the board the day before.

2

SHUTTLE – LINE 2, PASSY <> SAINT GERVAIS

Le Fayet (Gare) → Saint Gervais

EVERY 20 MIN → 02:00

The only **follower** line calling at Le Fayet station, and the latest-running line in France.

UNVERIFIED

The poster prints **no stop named Saint Gervais** – they stop at Le Fayet (Gare), 300 m below the village. Ask if it climbs to La Poste. **No published time for that hop**: the 15 min is Passy→Le Fayet.

3

SHUTTLE – LINE 3, SAINT GERVAIS <> NDG

Saint Gervais (La Poste) → Contamines (UTMB)

EVERY 20 MIN → 01:00

20 MIN

First 16:30. **The reliable leg** – two-way, and it outlasts the cutoff. Contamines (UTMB) is the assistance point itself.

ON THE NIGHT

km 32.5 could come up around **21:30**; the cutoff is **00:00**. Be ready to wait.

UNVERIFIED

The **21:30** is estimated from a 17:45 start – not official. Watch LiveTrail.

GETTING BACK – BOTH OPTIONS END UNRESOLVED

OPTION A

Contamines → NDG → Chamonix, line 5 (every 30 min; **last departure 01:00** from NDG, 55 min, lands **~01:55**). **Nothing verified runs on to Les Houches.**

OPTION B

Stay down-valley: line 3 to Saint Gervais (01:00), line 2 to Le Fayet (02:00) – then the train, **if one runs**. Also follower-accessible: **post-race Chamonix > Cluses**, Maison Nordique **23:59 Fri / 04:00 Sat** → Le Fayet **00:30 / 04:30**. **Never Les Houches.**

NIGHT RETURN TO LES HOUCHE IS UNSOLVED

CRITICAL

After U3 on Friday night you are back in Chamonix around **01:25-01:55** – the last two line-5 departures from NDG are 00:30 and 01:00, and the ride is 55 min – and **there is no verified way home**. Line 1 finished at 20:14, the last train has **almost certainly gone** – **UNVERIFIED, confirm at the station** – and **no UTMB shuttle runs Chamonix → Les Houches at any hour**, verified against the official 20-line index. The same wall reappears Sunday if you route U11 back through Chamonix.

DO THIS BEFORE FRIDAY

Get a local taxi number and save it **offline in every phone**. Agree now who calls it and what it costs – the only unconditional answer.

OR DODGE IT ENTIRELY

Stay down-valley on the Saint-Gervais side – line 2 runs to 02:00 – and take the first morning train home.

U1 LES HOUCHE, KM 9.1 – YOUR OWN VILLAGE, FRI ~18:30-19:15

The course runs through the village about an hour in. Walk out and cheer – but it is a **water point and personal assistance is NOT permitted**: no food, kit or drinks. First legal assistance is U3.

UNVERIFIED

Estimated from a 17:45 start – not official. Watch LiveTrail.

U11

CHAMPEX-LAC

KM 130.5 · HOT MEAL · ASSISTANCE OK

CUTOFF

SUN 02:30

SWISS PASS

CARRY ID

DIFFICULTY

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THE HARD ONE. TWO LEGS, A NIGHT TRANSFER AT ORSIÈRES, AND A 20:14 DEADLINE.

ROUTE OUT – LEAVE LES HOUCHE BEFORE 20:14 SAT

1

BUS – CHAMONIX BUS LINE 1

Les Houches → Chamonix

BOARD BEFORE 20:14

Every 30 min from 05:40. **Hard deadline** – after 20:14 there is no verified way to Chamonix and the whole Swiss plan fails at leg 1.

2

SHUTTLE – LINE 8, CHAMONIX > ORSIÈRES

Chamonix (Maison Nordique) → Orsières

EVERY 45 MIN → 03:00 SUN

80 MIN

First 05:30 Sat. Board at **Maison Nordique**, not Grépon Bus. Calls at Vallorcine and Trient en route.

TRANSFER – ORSIÈRES, IN THE DARK

Both lines run every 30-45 min, so the wait should be short.

UNVERIFIED

No confirmed indoor waiting area. Dress for standing outside at 01:00.

3

SHUTTLE – LINE 9, ORSIÈRES <> CHAMPEX-LAC

Orsières → Champex Lac

EVERY 30 MIN → 04:00 SUN

25 MIN

Runs 90 min past the cutoff – genuine margin on this leg.

GETTING BACK – OUT THROUGH TRIENT, NOT BACK THROUGH CHAMONIX

DO THIS

Every leg below is printed **two-way**, and it ends at Vallorcine where your own free train line starts. Chamonix – and the 20:14 problem – never comes up.

Champex → Orsières 25m → Trient 45m, last 04:00 → Vallorcine 15m, last 09:00 Sun → train home

NOT THIS

Line 8 is printed **one way** and no Orsières return is published anywhere. **And never detour to La Fouly** – it dies at 23:00 while everything else runs to 04:00.

THE THREE LOCAL-TRANSPORT FACTS EVERYTHING HANGS ON

NOT UTMB SHUTTLES – THESE ARE THE LOCAL SERVICES

CHAMONIX BUS LINE 1

VERIFIED

Les Houches <> Chamonix <> Les Praz/Flégère. **Every 30 min, daily, 05:40-20:14**. Summer timetable 21 Jun-7 Sep covers race weekend. **20:14 drives every decision on this sheet.**

UNVERIFIED

Whether Line 1 keeps normal hours on race weekend, and whether the Guest Card makes it free. The network map shows a road-closure icon at Les Houches.

MONT-BLANC EXPRESS

VERIFIED

Calls at **Les Houches station**, next door to the base. **Servoz → Vallorcine is free with the Carte d'Hôte (Guest Card)** from the accommodation, and Les Houches, Chamonix and Vallorcine all sit inside that section.

UNVERIFIED

All times at Les Houches; last train from Le Fayet; first and last from Vallorcine; race-weekend working.

CHAMO'NUIT NIGHT BUS

BIGGEST GAP

A night service by this name exists and the fare is known: **€4.50 by card / €5.00 cash, paid on board.**

UNVERIFIED

Everything else. Route, stops, hours, nights – and crucially **whether it serves Les Houches at all**. Build no return plan on it until someone confirms it in person.

PASSES ARE ZONE-BASED

Sold per race and per country. U3 needs FRANCE, U7 ITALY, U11 SWITZERLAND; U13 by train needs none. Booking closed 12/07/2026 – no on-site sales, no resale. Board with the emailed QR code; screenshot it offline, the valleys have no signal.

NO PRIVATE CARS · TWO CHAMONIX HUBS

Roads and parking are closed to cars at Les Contamines, Saint-Gervais, Courmayeur, La Fouly, Champex, Col de la Forclaz, Trient and Vallorcine. In Chamonix **Grépon Bus** serves the start and **Maison Nordique** serves runner-following – **except the St Gervais direction**, which the map legend (item 9) excludes; that is line 1, boarded at Grépon Bus. 10 min apart, the wrong one costs an hour.

U7

COURMAYEUR

KM 83.4 · HOT MEAL · LIFE BASE · DROP BAG

CUTOFF

SAT 13:15

ITALY PASS

CARRY ID – TUNNEL CROSSING

DIFFICULTY

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THE EASY ONE. DAYLIGHT, FREQUENT BUSES BOTH WAYS.

ROUTE OUT – TWO HOPS, THEN THE SAME TWO BACK

1

BUS – CHAMONIX BUS LINE 1

Les Houches → Chamonix

EVERY 30 MIN, 05:40-20:14

Nothing earlier – that would be a taxi.

2

SHUTTLE – LINE 6, CHAMONIX <> COURMAYEUR

Chamonix → Courmayeur (Centre Sportif)

EVERY 30 MIN, 00:30 → 20:30

45 MIN

Two-way all day. Board at **Maison Nordique**, not Grépon Bus.

BACK

Reverse it – but **be in Chamonix before 20:14** or Line 1 is finished. Easy with a 13:15 cutoff. Courmayeur is a life base with a hot meal and drop bags: plan a long stop.

U13

VALLORCINE

KM 158.4 · FOOD · LAST ASSISTANCE BEFORE THE FINISH

CUTOFF

SUN 11:15

NO UTMB PASS NEEDED

GUEST CARD

DIFFICULTY

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THE EASIEST ONE. ONE TRAIN, FROM YOUR DOORSTEP, FREE WITH THE GUEST CARD.

ROUTE OUT AND BACK – DAYLIGHT SUNDAY

1

TRAIN – MONT-BLANC EXPRESS, UP-VALLEY

Les Houches → Vallorcine → and back

Both stations are inside the free Servoz-Vallorcine section, so the Guest Card covers the trip. No Chamonix, no UTMB pass, and daylight on Sunday – no night-return problem here.

UNVERIFIED

Train times at Les Houches. Check the board.

FALLBACK – ONLY IF THE TRAIN FAILS

Line 13, Chamonix <> Vallorcine to 12:30 Sun – needs Chamonix, costs a pass, zone disputed.

CONFIRM TOMORROW

IN PERSON

☐ LAST TRAIN CHAMONIX → LES HOUCHE – the leg it all turns on.

☐ A Guest Card for every crew member – ask at check-in.

☐ Chamo'Nuit: does it stop in Les Houches, which nights, first and last?

☐ Last train from Le Fayet up-valley to Les Houches.

☐ Last train from Vallorcine – and the first one Sunday.

☐ A local taxi number, saved offline in every phone.

☐ Photograph the timetable board at Les Houches station.

☐ Does the Passy shuttle reach Saint Gervais village (La Poste)?

☐ Every QR code covers the zones needed – FR, IT **and** CH.

PROVENANCE

The routing here is *derived*, not published – no UTMB document is written for a Les Houches crew. Built from the official follower timetable, network map, cutoffs and verified local facts, retrieved 2026-08-26. Every unconfirmed step is marked UNVERIFIED. **Duration badges here are the printed time for that hop**, not the whole line; end-to-end figures are overleaf, with the source URL.

FRANCE – FRI 28/08	1CHAMONIX > CONTAMINES ONE WAY 50 MIN 17:30 Chamonix GRÉPON BUS 18:00 Saint Gervais LE PONT 18:20 Contamines NDG FREQUENCY EVERY 15 MIN → 20:30 Outbound only – the return is line 5. Boards at Grépon Bus. Its 20:30 finish is why it is the wrong line for U3.	2PASSY <> SAINT GERVAIS TWO WAY 15 MIN 16:00 Passy P+R 16:05 Mountain Store 16:15 Le Fayet GARE FREQUENCY EVERY 20 MIN → 02:00 (29/08) The only follower line calling at Le Fayet (Gare), the train station, and the latest-running line in France. The runner start and post-race shuttles call there too – both legend-marked accessible to followers. Notet no stop actually named Saint Gervais is printed.	3SAINT GERVAIS <> NDG TWO WAY 30 MIN (25) 16:30 Saint Gervais LA POSTE 16:50 Contamines UTMB 17:00 Notre Dame de la Gorge FREQUENCY EVERY 20 MIN → 01:00 (29/08) The workhorse line for U3. Two-way, every 20 min, running an hour past the Contamines cutoff.	4CONTAMINES <> NDG TWO WAY 10 MIN 17:30 Contamines UTMB 17:40 Notre Dame de la Gorge FREQUENCY EVERY 10 MIN → 23:59[‡] A short local hop between the Contamines aid station and NDG. It dies an hour before line 3 – never make it the last move of the night.	5NDG > CHAMONIX ONE WAY 55 MIN (50) 20:30 Notre Dame de la Gorge 20:50 Saint Gervais LE PONT 21:25 Chamonix MAISON NORDIQUE FREQUENCY EVERY 30 MIN → 01:00 (29/08) The return from the Contamines valley. 55 min end to end, so the last departure (01:00 from NDG) lands in Chamonix ~01:55, with nothing onward to Les Houches. It also calls at Saint Gervais.	H HOUCHES > CHAMONIX SINGLE RUN 35 MIN 16:00 Houches PRARION 16:05 Houches MAIRIE 16:15 Les Bossons 16:35 Chamonix GRÉPON BUS RUNNER START SHUTTLE – FOLLOWERS ALLOWED ONE BUS, ONE TIME, 28/08 Not a follower line, but the poster legend marks it accessible to followers. Your one guaranteed ride out of Les Houches all weekend. Nothing brings you back.
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ITALY – SAT 29/08	6CHAMONIX <> COURMAYEUR TWO WAY 45 MIN 00:30 Chamonix MAISON NORDIQUE 01:15 Courmayeur CENTRE SPORTIF FREQUENCY EVERY 30 MIN → 20:30 Through the Mont-Blanc tunnel. Two-way and frequent all day – this is what makes U7 the easy crew point. Italy pass · carry ID.	7COURMAYEUR <> ARNOUVAZ TWO WAY 45 MIN 07:30 Courmayeur CENTRE SPORTIF 08:15 Arnouvaz FREQUENCY EVERY 60 MIN → 18:30 (30/08) Out to the Arnouvaz aid station (U9, km 101.7). Hourly – the sparsest line on the network, so a missed bus costs a full hour. Spectating only.	HOW TO READ THIS SHEET “EVERY N MIN → HH:MM” – MEANING UNVERIFIED The source does not state whether that closing figure is the last departure or the end of service, and nobody has confirmed which. Treat it as the last moment you can rely on, be at the stop 20 min early, and never let the final connection of the night depend on it. ONE WAY VS TWO WAY Reproduced exactly as the poster prints each line. Lines 1, 5 and 8 are one-way. For line 8 a return must physically exist – it runs to 03:00 Sunday – but none is published, so do not plan on it. TWO CHAMONIX HUBS Grépon Bus serves the race start; Maison Nordique serves runner-following – except the St Gervais direction. The Chamonix map legend qualifies item 9 in as many words: “Race tracking – except St Gervais direction UTMB”. That exception is line 1, and the timetable duly boards it at Grépon Bus. They are ~10 min apart on foot and the wrong one costs an hour. ON BOARD Boarding is by the QR code emailed at booking; all of one person’s journeys sit under a single code. No children under 3 – both posters. On animals and wheels the two disagree: the FR follower timetable, the primary source here, forbids pets, bikes and scooters outright (“il est interdit d’emmener des animaux de compagnie, vélos et trottinettes”); the EN Chamonix poster only <i>recommends</i> against them and leaves each driver free to refuse. Plan on the FR rule. ‡ THE 23:59 ON LINE 4 The poster prints “23:59M”. That is a typographic error in the official artwork – the other calls read “02:00AM”, “01:00AM”, so an “A” has been dropped. It is 23:59. TIMES PAST MIDNIGHT A bracketed date means the time belongs to the following day: line 2’s “02:00 (29/08)” is 2 a.m. on the Saturday. NOTHING RETURNS TO LES HOUCHES Verified against the official 20-line index: the only line touching Les Houches is Houches > Chamonix – one way, one run, 16:00 Friday. TIMETABLES CAN CHANGE MID-EVENT Both posters warn that times may vary – but they name different channels. The FR follower timetable (primary) says any change is communicated via the website (“via le site internet”); the EN Chamonix poster says by SMS. Watch both: carry the number on the booking, <i>and</i> check the UTMB site before you leave.	AND WHAT THE POSTER DOES NOT TELL YOU
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SWITZERLAND – SAT 29/08	8CHAMONIX > ORSIÈRES ONE WAY 80 MIN (90) 05:30 Chamonix MAISON NORDIQUE 05:55 Vallorcine GARE 06:10 Trient 06:50 Orsières FREQUENCY EVERY 45 MIN → 03:00 (30/08) The trunk line into Switzerland and the gateway to U11. Calls at Vallorcine 25 min in, so you can join it there instead of Chamonix. Printed one way.	9ORSIÈRES <> CHAMPEX-LAC TWO WAY 25 MIN (30) 07:00 Orsières 07:25 Champex Lac FREQUENCY EVERY 30 MIN → 04:00 (30/08) The final leg to U11, two-way and running 90 min past Suha’s 02:30 cutoff – real margin. Swiss pass required.	10ORSIÈRES <> LA FOULY TWO WAY 25 MIN (30) 07:15 Orsières 07:40 La Fouly FREQUENCY EVERY 30 MIN → 23:00 A trap. It dies at 23:00 while every other Swiss line runs to 04:00 – detour here and you can be stranded. U10 is spectating only. Swiss pass.	11ORSIÈRES <> TRIENT TWO WAY 45 MIN 08:45 Orsières 09:30 Trient FREQUENCY EVERY 30 MIN → 04:00 (30/08) Key return link. Chained with line 12 it gives you a published two-way way out of Switzerland that does not depend on line 8. Also serves U12 Trient.	12TRIENT <> VALLORCINE TWO WAY 15 MIN 09:00 Trient 09:15 Vallorcine FREQUENCY EVERY 30 MIN → 09:00 (30/08) Your safety net. Runs longer than any other line and drops you at Vallorcine, where the Mont-Blanc Express goes straight home. Border crossing – carry ID.	13CHAMONIX <> VALLORCINE TWO WAY 30 MIN (35-40) 05:00 Chamonix MAISON NORDIQUE 05:30 Vallorcine FREQUENCY EVERY 30 MIN → 12:30 (30/08) For a Les Houches crew the train beats this outright. UNVERIFIED Which pass it needs. Printed in the Switzerland column, but the map legend lists it under both France (35 min) and Switzerland (40 min).
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PASSES & BOOKING Zone-based. Passes are sold per race and per country. Champex-Lac and La Fouly need the SWITZERLAND pass. Courmayeur and Arnouvaz need ITALY. Everything on the France band needs FRANCE. Check every crew member’s QR code covers the zone before leaving the flat – a wrong-zone pass is refused at the door of the bus. Booking closed 12 July 2026. No on-site sales and resale is not permitted – nothing further can be bought now. Board with the QR code emailed at booking; all of one person’s journeys are grouped under a single code. Screenshot it offline.	ROAD CLOSURES – NO PRIVATE CARS Roads and parking are closed to private cars for the duration of the event at Les Contamines, Saint-Gervais, Courmayeur, La Fouly, Champex, Col de la Forclaz, Trient and Vallorcine. Access is only possible by UTMB Mobility shuttle – or, where it runs, by train. The network map also shows a road-closure icon at Les Houches, which is not in the guide’s written list. UNVERIFIED Extent and timing of any Les Houches closure, and whether it affects Line 1’s routing. Confirm locally.	SOURCE RETRIEVED 2026-08-26 PRIMARY: UTMB_FR – “Horaires des navettes <> Chamonix – ACCOMPAGNANTS”. https://res.cloudinary.com/utmb-world/image/upload/v1/montblanc/Transports/UTMB_FR/UTMB_final2_175df14f2a Retrieved 2026-08-26: all 13 lines transcribed verbatim and re-checked against the local copy at 200%. UTMB never published an English equivalent of the follower timetable – it exists in French only. THIS SHEET IS THE ENGLISH RENDERING. Supporting: EN_UTMB_1 (start & post-race), EN_UTMB_3 (network map, journey times, zone legend), EN_UTMB_4 (line index), Transport Guide 2026 (passes, closures).
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